

MYLAPORE

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ASSOCIATION HONOURS ALUMNAE SERVING AS PRINCIPALS

Alumnae Association of Justice Basheer Ahmed Sayeed College for Women organised the reunion **P3**



TARPAULIN IS JUST THE 'TRAILER'

At Nehru Market, there is more to the tarpaulin shops than their name suggests **P4**

Where the water in the sump is as dark as black ink

Certain parts of Mandaveli report sewage contamination in water being supplied by CMWSSB

In various parts of Mandaveli, residents are complaining of sewage contamination in the water being supplied by Chennai Metro Water Supply & Sewerage Board (CMWSSB).

K.L. Balasubramanian, a key member of RK Nagarra, a group that represents the interests of residents of various streets in RK Nagar, says that the water supplied by

CMWSSB is patchy in terms of quality.

"There can be clean water for three days on the trot, and then on the fourth day, there is contaminated water to deal with. This pattern suggests the source changes and some of the sources of water supply are contaminated," he explains.

People who watch their sump regularly notice this pattern. He re-



A resident of a street in RK Nagar drains the contaminated water from the sump.

marks that sometimes the contamination is beyond description, the water in the sump being inky-dark. Balasubramanian notes that areas where this problem is noticed include Jeth Nagar and some streets of RK Nagar. As a result of this problem, some residents in Mandaveli have turned entirely to alternative sources of water, bore wells and wells.



During the inauguration.



Bus commuters from Tondiarpet have got a leg-up with the establishment of a new terminus spread across 16,000 square feet on Ennore High Road. The facility was inaugurated on September 21.

Built by the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) at a cost of ₹ 2.5 crore, the new facility, known as Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) bus terminus, is located in Ward 38 of GCC, which covers Gandhi Nagar, Nethaji Nagar, Nehru Nagar and Patel Nagar.

Transport Minister A. Vijay Tamilan Parthiban and Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson took part in

An improved bus terminus in Tondiarpet

Residents request MTC to restore old bus routes in the region

the inauguration. It features dedicated waiting areas, a bus crew rest room, a nursing and lactation room, and modern restrooms for men, women, and persons with disabilities, and a time keeper room. This facility brings signifi-

cant relief and convenience to the residents of Tondiarpet, especially those in Ward 38, ending decades of wait for improved transport infrastructure, said a release.

Currently, 44C plies between IOC terminus and Island Grounds

and runs through Powerhouse, Tondairpet, Maharani, Vallalar Nagar and Beach Station.

At the launch event, Nethaji U Ganesan, Chairman of the Tondiarpet Zone of GCC, requested the Metropolitan Transport Corporation

to restore the previously suspended routes.

"If the Transport Department restores the bus services connecting this location to key hubs, including Koyambedu, Thiruvanniyur, Adyar, Tambaram, Anna Square, and Vadapalani, it would benefit thousands of commuters across 32 localities, including Nedunchezian Nagar, Nethaji Nagar, and Rajasekaran Nagar."

G S Sameeran, Commissioner, GCC, V P Jeyaseelan, Managing Director, Metropolitan Transport Corporation and Swetha Suman, Regional Deputy Commissioner (North), GCC participated.

Recycling all that clay

Here are ways to reuse the clay from Ganesh Chaturthi idols that have been left behind

MALINI KALAYANAM

Local garden nurseries are encouraged to use the clay from Ganesh Chaturthi idols that vendors have left behind. They can recycle this clay and make it saleable again by adding to it ingredients such as hay, saw dust, broken-down barks of trees, shredded paper, cocopeat, sugarcane molasses, mushroom molasses, perlite or sand, vegetable kitchen waste, garden soil and cow dung to make it suitable for the growth of saplings. This process of addition would make it a rich compost.

Creating immense value from anything that is discarded is highly appreciated and prevents the

landfills from getting overburdened.

Business opportunities extend by routing this into different pathways suitable for different kinds of plants with composition changes in the ingredients' mix.

Instead of dumping the clay in waterbodies, we must ensure the clay is either reused by potters or reused by potential garden enthusiasts or local garden nurseries.

Clay contains nutrients and minerals that can help plants when combined with other ingredients as a mix. People are dissuaded from purchasing painted Ganeshas moving forward, as this is not suitable for plants and can be hazardous as paints contain chemicals. Even if it is being



From a clay Ganesha making workshop.

reused by potters, they find it difficult for reuse as paints are hazardous and can create allergic reactions. It is people who create the demand. Be a responsible and informed buyer.

When one stops buying painted or coloured Ganeshas, their supply diminishes automatically.

Sellers buy their supply based on the market demand.

Do not give room for Plaster of Paris idols either as they are painted and cannot be dissolved in water after Visarjan.

Celebrating the Ganesha festival and maintaining the tradition and culture with reverence is im-

portant but celebrating it responsibly is the need of the hour.

(Malini Kalyanam, a social activist and environmentalist, is director of Artistic Pottery Training Academy in Kattupakkam, and founder trustee, The PALM, a public charitable trust that empowers women)

75,000 trees and a green movement

To commemorate 75 years of Chinmaya Mission, its school at Taylor's Road has launched an ambitious tree planting drive



Dignitaries at the launch of Chinmaya Amritavanam.

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Staff and students of Chinmaya Vidyalaya at Taylor's Road in Kilpauk have begun to put their green thumbs to work. Recently, the school launched "Chinmaya Amritavanam", an ambitious initiative to plant and nurture 75,000 trees to commemorate 75 years of the Chinmaya Mission, during the school's 59th Annual Day celebrations. This would mean every activity around planting and nurtur-

ing these saplings will involve students across classes.

Built around the theme "75 Years, 75,000 Trees, One Living Legacy," the initiative envisages planting 1,000 trees for every year of Chinmaya Mission's journey, creating a lasting green legacy while engaging students and the wider community in environmental stewardship, says a press note.

The school has chalked out a plan to fulfil this mission of increasing the green cover in and around the city.

Geetha Ganesh, principal, Chin-

maya Vidyalaya, says the school will be responsible for taking care of the plants for the next five years, and they are implementing the project in a phased manner involving other institutions as well.

"There are eight other sister schools of Chinmaya Vidyalaya in the city who will also be part of this initiative, they will be taking saplings and growing them on their campus. Likewise, our neighbouring schools Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyasharm and Maharishi Vidya Mandir in Chetpet have also agreed to be part of the green drive," says



Geetha.

The plants are geo-tagged, which means the GPS coordinates and species details will be available. Among activities that the school is planning include a visit to Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited where students would initiate the drive.

The event

■ Chinmaya Amritavanam was formally inaugurated by V. Karunapriya, Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests and Managing Director, TAFCORN.

■ Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL) will receive 5,000 saplings for Green Belt Development at Amullavoyal, Manali. Sri Sriram Vishwanathan, Chief General Manager (HSE), CPCL, received a sapling on behalf of CPCL, marking the first major commitment towards the 75,000-tree goal.

■ The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) is also partnering with Chinmaya Vidyalaya in taking the initiative forward.

■ B. Chandra Mohan, IAS; Leena Nair, IAS (Retd.), Chairperson, Chinmaya Vidyalayas, Chennai; O. V. Nambiar, Zonal Director, Chinmaya Vidyalayas, Chennai; Sri Jaishankar Unnithan, Honorary Correspondent; were among the special guests at the event..

No SWD in streets in George Town?



ILYAS HAIDARI

Every year, before the onset of the North East Monsoon, we read in newspapers about steps being taken by the civic body. One important work is to fix potholes and avoid waterlogging. Residents of VOC Nagar in George Town are struggling to cope with these issues even during the intermittent showers that the city experiences. Most of the streets do not have stormwater drains or any channel for rainwater to flow, which results in water stagnation for hours even after a short spell of rain. Uneven road surface with potholes and dumping of garbage make the slushy road difficult to walk and dangerous to drive. Even newly laid roads lack stormwater drains.

Ilyas Haidari is a resident of Angappa Street

Taxis block access to TTK Road

RAMDAS NAIK

On TTK Road, almost every evening, the call taxis queue up on the wrong side of the road, which is a one-way from Seethamma Road to the TTK signal to enter the HP petrol bunk to fill up CNG gas. This

a nuisance for people wanting to enter Apollo Pharmacy/Chaikings and other shops on the right side as the taxis block the road. Besides, there are no traffic police presence anywhere on the stretch at both signals during the peak hours.

Ramdas Naik is a resident of CIT Colony



Looking for stamp paper in Mandaveli?

BASKAR SESHADRI

Stamp paper in Mylapore and Mandaveli seemed to have become scarce after the old vendor Vasantha passed away a few months ago. Now it is available at VC Garden Street, Mandaveli.

Anantharaman, the vendor, he opens between 11 a.m. and 6 p.m. on all weekdays. It's closed on Saturdays and Sundays and all government holidays since sale of stamp paper should not



take place on government holidays as per the rule.

Anantharaman's house-cum-shop is at 33 V C Garden Street, near the RTO. For all the stamp paper needs, court fee stamps and green document sheets this place can be approached. They do not accept Gpay.

New venue in Mylapore

Sri Vedantha Desikar Devasthanam recently opened a spacious hall at Chitrakulam South Street, near the Aavin parlour.

With a seating capacity for 100 people and fully airconditioned, this space is suitable for upanayanam, discourses and for small function. Kamala Thothadri Hall, as it is named, should be ideal for music programmes especially kutchcheris.

During the inauguration in June, a discourse by Dushyant Sridhar was performed.

For details, call 044 - 4953799 / 43863747.

Baskar Seshadri is a resident of Mylapore

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Association honours alumnae serving as principals

Alumnae Association of Justice Basheer Ahmed Sayeed College for Women organised the reunion

The Alumnae Association of Justice Basheer Ahmed Sayeed College for Women (Autonomous) organised its Alumnae Reunion 2026 recently at the college campus, celebrating the achievements of its former students under the theme "Echoes of Excellence - The Legacy of Leadership."

The Lifetime Achievement Award was presented to Bader Sayeed, an alumna of the Class of 1966, in recognition of her contribution and leadership. The Distinguished Alumnae Achievement Award was presented to Geethanjali (Class of 2000), Director of Academics, Velammal Trust, and Pa-



vithra J. (Class of 2005), Founder and Principal, Vrindavan Global Pre School and Vrindavan International Montessori Training.

The fact that all ten recipients of the Alumnae Achievement Award are serving as Principals made this year's felicitation particularly sig-

nificant and reinforced the reunion's focus on leadership and excellence in education, said a press release.

An award for SPASTN director

Rotary Club of Madras conferred its prestigious 'Educator Extraordinaire Award' on L. V. Jayashree, director, The Spastics Society of Tamil Nadu (SPASTN), for her outstanding service in education, rehabilitation and inclusion of persons with disabilities.

The award was presented by president Rtn. S. Balakrishna along with Rtn. Archana Shri Sanjay, Director - Vocational Services, at the Club's weekly meeting.

Jayashree, who has dedicated her life to empowering persons with disabilities to lead independent and dignified lives, said she was deeply honoured and dedicated the award to her team working behind the scenes.



Old Markets, New Trends is a column that features markets that have continued to retain their hold on people's mindscape despite the shifting sands of fads. Through entities that have been around for a long time, it seeks to find out what makes these markets tick

Tarpaulin is just the 'trailer'

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Umbrellas are a victim of "folk association". They are certainly not the sole preserve of the monsoon with its drippy skies, but that is the period they get busier and therefore, get almost entirely associated with the rains. The tarpaulin shops at Nehru Market on Sydenhams Road in Periamet are busy through the year and get a tad busier when the monsoon is round the corner.

But one peek into these tarpaulin shops and there is not a shred of doubt about their all-year relevance. And now, tarpaulin seems like a generic term for a whole range of products that offer a protective cover to valuables. These shops sell those green shade nets for gardens, tents for camping, cotton canvas covers, car covers and bags (which are also covers, glorified covers). These bags are not high-fashion, but made of heavy-duty material and designed to last.

Tarpaulins of various thickness and materials, both determining their prices, are a dominant presence, but one can always shop for more than tarpaulins.

At Nehru Market, there is more to the tarpaulin shops than their name suggests. Their range includes camp tents for the outdoor-oriented and shade nets for those with a green thumb. With the NE monsoon (when they are a tad busier) just weeks away, a look at what helps them cope with changing buyer behaviour



Tarpaulin shops at Nehru Market. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Nehru Market is next door to Anna Market, which is dominated by sale of metal items, many of them massive spare parts that go into the running of industrial machinery. The first few shops at Nehru Market are tarpaulin shops, wholesale and retail, but step in-

side and the shops selling spare parts for industrial machinery predominate. These two markets are not next door neighbours but closer than that, as united as two intercommunicating rooms with a common door. The tarpaulin shops and those selling used spare parts for

industrial machinery exist side by side, by design.

Anil Kumar of Prakash Trading Company points out that these tarpaulin covers are used to cover machinery, among other things. While out here to purchase metal parts for heavy-duty industrial machinery, someone might pick up tarpaulins too. These shops also draw adventurers who like to camp out in a temporary shelter under the skies. Similarly, those with a green thumb. The green shade nets are for them.

Anil Kumar notes that almost every shop, the wholesale shops for certain, would have a tailor attached to it. The tents, shade nets and cotton canvas have to be made to order, often. Promptness is a key factor driving success and survival in this business.

Many of these tarpaulin shops are carryovers from a different era, one pithily defined as "Moore Market". Following the Moore Market fire in the 1980s, traders fanned out depending on where they were allocated a space. That is how some

of the tarpaulin sellers ended up in Nehru Market, managed by Greater Chennai Corporation.

Anil Kumar shoulders the weight of a legacy: the shop was established by his father Narayan Jha over 50 years ago. He worked alongside his father and brother before their deaths, and now the weight of that legacy is entirely on his shoulders. And he finds it to be excruciatingly heavy not only due to the lack of support from a kindred soul, but also market realities. "Counter sales has dwindled," says Anil. "Demand has generally fallen with online shopping changing the way customers buy."

So this is where it stands: much of the regular business comes from factories that use the material to cover machinery, as well as from transporters. Anil qualifies that, saying there is still demand for shade nets, tents, car covers and other items but there is huge competition from various quarters.

The promise of getting items at wholesale rates or even purse-friendly retail rates continues to hold out an attraction for the cost-conscious, and they hit Nehru market. Another shop seller, who does not want to be named, points out that tarpaulins, camping tents and car covers are available at wholesale prices on a section of Walltax Road, largely Ramanan Road and near Elephant Gate Street. But Nehru Market in Sydenhams Road scores on ease of access.

LIFFY THOMAS

More than 11,500 kilos of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing nets, known as ghost nets, were collected in the last three months from the Chennai coast, largely from the Neelankarai-to-Kovalam section. That is just the tip of the iceberg. Tonnes of them are yet to be retrieved from our long coastline, many entangled around marine animals preventing them from moving freely.

“In fact, when the North East Monsoon sets in, the quantity of ghost nets being collected also increases depending on the wind pattern seen during the months of October to March. From December onwards, the ghost nets are observed floating closer to the shore,” says Supraja Dharani, founder of TREE Foundation, a Chennai-based non-governmental organisation that focuses on marine conservation.

Since 2021, the Foundation has been playing a key role in removing tonnes of ghost nets by empowering different stakeholders attached to the seas, the local community and the fishers being their chief ambassadors.

As part of capacity building programmes, they conduct workshops to train fishers in identifying and retrieving a net by steering their boats towards it, looking for marine species in the net, releasing it and pulling the net closer to the boat and bringing it to the shores where it is weighed and sent for recycling.

Tree Foundation currently works in the Chennai-Chengalpattu stretch of the coast, many parts of Andhra Pradesh starting from Sullurpeta, Bapatla, Prakasham, Godavari, Vizianagaram and Srikakulam, southern Odisha and western Goa.

Sea Turtle Protection Force

“Our work in retrieving ghost nets extends to more than 800 km, 285 fishing villages, and 411 fishing



Fishing for ghost nets

Through its Sea Turtle Protection Force, TREE Foundation has built an army of fishers who retrieve ghost nets from the sea



An awareness programme by TREE Foundation for fishermen about ghost nets; and (above) fishermen retrieve abandoned nets.

community members who are part of the Sea Turtle Protection Force; they are the point of contact for fishers of the respective villages,”

says Supraja.

One of the biggest motivations for fishers to retrieve ghost nets is the incentive they receive for the

quantity they collect.

The amount of payment depends on the weight of the net. “Fifty percent of the amount goes to their bank account and the rest to the wife’s or mother’s account, which is used for children’s education, repair of nets and medical emergencies,” says the marine activist.

In the last five years, 217 tonnes of ghost nets have been handed to the TREE Foundation. To further felicitate those who have removed the maximum quantity of ghost nets, a felicitation event is held, usually in the first week of October, where other stakeholders including officers from the Coast Guard and Fisheries department are invited.

“Our success is the result of awareness programmes that we conduct teaching the fisherman how to release entangled endangered marine life including turtles, retrieve the ghost net and hand it over to TREE Foundation. Till date 974 marine megafauna have been released by the fishermen all recorded by videos or photos,” she

says.

The abandoned nets are weighed and sent for recycling. The Foundation has made a pathway at its biodiversity centre in Marakkanam.

Finding corporates willing to support the programme financially is a challenge, and Supraja says they are grateful to be supported by Royal Enfield and AstraZeneca in the ghost net retrieval and incentivisation programme for fishermen along Chengalpattu and Chennai coast.

The weight of these nets range from 100 to 700 kilos and tying it to their boats and bringing it to the shore is not easy.

“We want more corporates to support us in other coastal areas as well. We are soon going to set up a small unit where the nets will be shredded and made into small tiles,” she says. More support from corporates would mean getting more fishermen to join the diving team.

Removing ghost nets entangled in coral reefs will also be an extension of Foundation’s work.

Extending from coast to coast

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

If you are a certified diver then HCL Foundation, the CSR arm of HCL Technologies, should be happy to engage your service to scour the ocean depths for ghost nets. Under HCL Harit, the Foundation has been playing a key role in removing ghost nets.

Started in 2022 from the Chennai coast in Neelankarai, today the initiative extends along the Gulf of Mannar, coasts along Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

As per data, they have successfully mapped, retrieved, and repurposed nearly 4 lakh plus kilograms of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing gear (ALDFG), across several distinct coastal locations in India.

In the Gulf of Mannar, more than 12.9 metric tons of ghost nets have been removed from ecologically sensitive habitats surrounding 21 islands. In Kundapura, Karnataka, they have launched an innovative buy-back model that incentivises fishers to return dis-

carded nets, helping recover over 10,000 kg of ghost gear.

Nidhi Pundhir, vice-president - Global CSR, HCL Tech and Director, HCL Foundation, says they have a MoU with the Ministry of Environment, and over the years they have built a nationwide coalition involving scientific institutions, diving teams, fisher communities, the Indian Coast Guard, coastal police, and grassroot organisations to tackle marine debris.

A dedicated ghost gear man-

agement component was integrated into the Fisher Friend Mobile Application, enabling real time tracking and reporting of ghost gear by fishing communities.

Nidhi says there is a whole process involved in recycling the ghost nets that serves as a supplementary income for communities. “When we get these nets, they have a whole lot of salt coating on it and is not easily recyclable. We are doing a lot of R&D including converting them into nets which are used for various sports activities, designing bags and for other creative use,” says Nidhi.

To engage university students

to design upcycled, functional products from the retrieved nylons, the Foundation conducted the Ghost Net Innovation Challenge. Recently, on International Coastal Cleanup Day, the Foundation organised a mega cleanup campaign of oceans, involving volunteer and community members.

“From CSR design point of view, we have been thinking that we really need to take a district-level kind of an approach in certain places where we have higher employee strength. And we have been looking at a “convergence model” as our next step,” says Nidhi.

At Mudichur, birders chanced upon a Java sparrow while having gone there in the hope of seeing another bird species. The Java sparrow is a breeding resident in parts of Indonesia. And this particular individual is likely a captive bird that had slipped out of a cage, raising questions about the sordid side of the pet trade

PRINCE FREDERICK

The backdrop can sometimes cast a sombre shadow over a stage pulsating with a grand achievement. Knowing the backstory can automatically signal restraint, cutting out celebration, even justified celebration, without a twinge of regret. An extensively reported event this year would make this idea clearer. Royal Challengers Bangalore cut out the victory parade following their triumph in IPL 2026 clearly because the “backdrop” of a tragic stampede the previous year loomed large casting a long shadow over a merry moment that played out on a grand stage. Something parallel to that, sans the sombreness, happened recently in the Chennai Metropolitan Area.

Over a week’s duration, the start date being September 19, Mudichur in Tambaram witnessed a parade of birders out to catch a glimpse of a rare avian, so rare that when news of its sighting hit their “auriculars”, some dropped their telephoto zoom lens. It was a Java sparrow (*Padda oryzivora*) found in parts of Indonesia, Java being one of them, where they are meant to be found. The sad story (actually, the backstory birders out here were aware of) is that this bird is also found where it has no business poking its beak around, and it is not to be blamed for that. Aviculture and, in a larger sense, human beings’ innate ability honed by greed to interfere with Nature’s delicate but sound systems. The birders sensed this bird could have slipped past the open shutter of some cage

here, and that knowledge tempered the sense of having found something rare. They clicked away still, but there was restraint in their posts about the sighting.

Birders Jithesh Babu and Saravanan Manian had discovered the Java sparrow in Mudichur serendipitously while seeking to pay another bird a visit, a passage migrant in Chennai.

“On September 19, we were there looking for the European roller, which was reported to have been sighted at Mudichur,” says Jithesh. The European roller (*Coracias garulus*) not showing up immediately, the birders ventured a little further in than they had expected to, and

there it was, a surprise in a package of red, pink, grey, black and white: a Java sparrow with, probably until recently, a local address on its calling card.

If the European roller had a sense of humour and the power of speech to express it, it surely would have rasped out “and you thought I was the surprise!” The European roller breeds in Europe and winters in Africa and is known to ink in Chennai as a pit stop on its iconic long-distance migration, almost treated as a sub category in migration, being dubbed “roller migration”. Last year, European roller sighting was reported from the Broken Bridge area of the Adyar Estuary.

Java sparrow and (above) European roller at Mudichur on September 19.
PHOTOS: JITHESH BABU



VELS University honours 1,000 school teachers



VELS University organised the VELS Teachers Excellence Awards 2026 across its various campuses. As part of the Teachers' Day celebrations, the felicitation ceremony was held at the VELS University campus in Pallavaram. Premalatha Vijayakant, MLA, Virudhachalam Constituency and general secretary, DMDK, graced the occasion as chief guest and felicitated the teachers, says a press release.

Preethaa Ganesh, vice president, VELS University, said that "teaching is the finest profession, as it creates and shapes all other professions."

Premalatha Vijayakant recalled the teacher who had a significant influence on her during her school years. She said: "Teachers carry the great responsibility of guiding students on the right path. Captain



▼ Premalatha Vijayakant with the awardees

Vijayakant deeply understood the importance of education and extended educational assistance to thousands of students to help them continue their studies. Behind the success of every student, there is the contribution of a teacher who guided and encouraged them. There was such a teacher in my

own life as well. A teacher named Loganathan guided me and played an important role in shaping me into the person I am today. Though he is no longer with us, I will always remember and acknowledge his contribution to all my achievements."

The VELS Teachers Excellence Awards 2026 have been instituted to recognise and honour the dedicated service of teachers who play a significant role in shaping students' knowledge, skills, character and future, says the press release.

The event was attended by Arthi Ganesh, pro chancellor, VELS University; M. Baskaran, vice chancellor; M. Chandrasekaran, registrar, and other senior members of the university administration.

K Mohandas Memorial Award for former Tamil Nadu DGP



K Ramanujam, former Director General of Police, Tamil Nadu, receives the award.

BForce, a charitable trust based in Chennai, operating with the aim of providing and facilitating the Tamil Nadu Police force and their families with medical assistance, specifically in the areas of management of cancer, was launched as a tribute to K. Mohandas IPS, former Director General of Police, Tamil Nadu and his wife, Santha Mohandas. K. Mohandas belonged to the 1956 batch of the Indian Police Service, Tamil Nadu cadre. The trust was established by the four daughters of the Mohandas couple.

A press release from B Force points out that to commemorate

its anniversary, B Force bestows an award instituted as "The K Mohandas Memorial Award". This award is conferred upon a past senior police officer who has contributed to the police force beyond the call of his duty.

This year, on September 22, 2026, to commemorate its 19th anniversary, B Force conducted an awards ceremony at Amir Mahal. Recipient of the prestigious award is K Ramanujam IPS, former Director General of Police, Tamil Nadu. As chief guest, Nawabzada Mohammed Asif Ali, Dewan to the Prince of Arcot presented and felicitated the decorated officer with the award.

135 school teachers in the limelight at Guru Dhakshina 2026



Agurchand Manmull Jain College, recently hosted its much-anticipated annual ceremony, Guru Dhakshina 2026, a celebration of gratitude recognising teachers at the Bhagwan Mahaveer Gyan Bhavan.

The college paid tribute to 135 school teachers, chosen from across schools in and around Chennai, says a press release. The ceremony was graced by an eminent panel of guests and dignitaries. Film actor, motivational speaker and

educationist Dhamu was chief guest. Founder of Farmguru Agritech was the guest of honour.

The event was also attended by Ushan Kumar Chordia, secretary; Hemant P. Chordia, associate secretary; N. Venkataramanan, director; M.M. Ramya, dean; and R. Surekha, deputy dean.

The ceremony featured a symbolic gesture of a student seeking blessings from a teacher, capturing the Guru-Shishya tradition.

City ophthalmologist honoured at conference in Bangkok



Ophthalmologist from Chennai Dr D P Prakash was invited to give a keynote speech on eye care at the United Nations Conference Centre in Bangkok

on September 25. The summit was on sustainable living and wellbeing, says a press release.

His presentation was titled "The World- First Artificial Intelligence Based Vision Care System."

In his address, the chief eye surgeon of American Eye Care Centre highlighted how India is losing a gross national income of 646 billion rupees due to the 70 million vision impaired population apart from

the 4.9 million blind people.

On the occasion, he received the Global Change Maker Award for his contribution towards advancing eye care and sustainable health care development from Dr. Giovanni Jing, UNESCO, Italy.

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PLAN YOUR WEEK

Inter-school oratorical competition

Union Christian Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Chetpet will be conducting the second edition of its inter-school oratorical competition, Oratoria'26, for students of classes VII to XII on October 29 and 30. The event would also feature a debate segment with an overall prize package worth ₹90,000 including a return ticket to an exotic destination, said a release. Scan the QR code to register. Contact: 73051 75551/97892 91683



Season two of Battle of Brains



Battle of Brains, an inter-school quiz, is back with its second season. Organised by Casagrand, in association with Nexus Consulting, schools across Chennai can register teams of two students from classes 6 to 10 at no cost. Re-

gistrations are open until October 5, 2026.

The event will be held from October 10 to November 15, 2026.

The winning teams from the zonal rounds will advance to the city final, where they will compete for the Battle of Brains Season 2 title.

The second season will also extend the quizzing experience beyond students with a dedicated parents and teachers quiz.

The first season saw enthusiastic participation from over 250 schools across Chennai. Sachin Sathyasivan and Perri Karthik Chidambaram from B. V. Bhavan's Rajaji Vidhyashram School were crowned the champions of Casagrand's Battle of Brains 2025, winning exciting prizes worth ₹4 lakh along with the prestigious trophy, said a release.

A photo contest for the deaf



Rotary club of Chennai Crown and Madras photobloggers are organising an exclusive photo contest for the deaf on nature conservation, as part of International Week of Deaf Awareness. The link for submission

is <http://tinyurl.com/YAAVARUM-PHOTOCONTEST>. The last date for submission is September.

Winners of the contest will be honoured during Wildlife Week 2026 in October.



A mini-fair at RAPRA's AGM

The annual meeting of Raja An-namalipuram Residents Association (RAPRA) was a mini trade fair. Held at Rajah Muthiah Higher Secondary School, this is the eleventh Annual General Meeting of the society.

Many exhibitors put up their stalls at the sprawling ground to display their products. Residents did their shopping before the meeting commenced. Horticulture, Textiles, Organic food, cars, inverters, solar power, mosquito nets, artificial jewellery, garbage bins were

some of the products displayed. Lawrence and Mayo did free eye test on this occasion.

Every year, RAPRA distributes financial assistance to 40 students of Chennai and government aided schools. This year too financial assistance worth ₹1.6 lakhs were disbursed to indigent students of these schools, said a release.

Bank of Baroda and N Gopaldaas jewellers made power point presentations on their schemes and varieties of diamonds respectively.

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A gamified approach to learning accounting and finance

The P. G. Department of Accounting & Finance of Ramakrishna Mission Vivekananda College Evening College, Mylapore, organised 'Finest '26' recently. More than 200 participants from 29 colleges took part in various events such as stock wars, forensic accounting treasure hunt, finquizathon, tughlaq durbar and business proposal presentation.

The Head of the Department, V. Manikantan, said the objective of the Inter-Collegiate Academic Meet was to help the students learn the innovative aspects of accounting and finance in a gamified approach.

Chief guest Moahan Venkatesan, retd.vice-president-head, Operations Legal Administration and Corporate Communication, Sundaram Finance was honoured by the college secretary, Swami Dhyanaagamyamanda.

The chief guest spoke about how adaptability and honesty are essential traits to be adopted by an individual as he enters corporate.

V.R. Manikandan was the chief guest at the valedictory function. The overall trophy was bagged by Guru Nanak College.

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